stable. Make sure to install the latter as we don't want any unexpected surprises getting in the way of your learning as you follow along with this book.

Go ahead and read the following instructions for your OS, then install Docker and meet me back here when you're done. Don't worry, I'll wait—there's nothing that floats my boat quite a like a brand-spanking-new Docker install.

macOS

Docker provides a downloadable installer called *Docker for Mac*, which has everything you need in one neat package (it's currently a 115.6 MB download). Go ahead and install this, following the installation instructions.[3]

Once installed, Docker for Mac adds a menu bar app in the top right of the screen featuring Docker's logo, which is its whale mascot affectionately named "Moby Dock." The menu bar not only tells you whether Docker is running, but it also provides other useful information and settings. You can find out more about the advanced settings available in docs.[4]

Linux

Unfortunately, getting started with Docker on Linux is a bit more involved than on other platforms. As you'd probably expect, how you install it depends on your Linux distribution.

Visit the Docker CE installation docs,[5] select your Linux distribution from the navigation menu, then follow the instructions. Typically, this involves installing Docker with your distro's package manager, which may need to get the latest packages from Docker's repository, as the distro packages are often outdated.

You'll also need to review Docker's post-installation instructions[6] to make sure you've got everything set up correctly. It will help you troubleshoot any issues you encounter.

In later chapters, we'll rely on a tool called *Docker Compose*, which, on Linux, is installed separately. Go ahead and install this using the documentation provided.[7] If you happen to have it installed already, I recommend upgrading to the latest, stable version.

3. https://docs.docker.com/docker-for-mac/install/
4. https://docs.docker.com/docker-for-mac/#preferences
5. https://docs.docker.com/install/
6. https://docs.docker.com/engine/installation/linux/linux-postinstall/
7. https://docs.docker.com/compose/install/